

COUNTER INFORMATION

MARCH/APRIL/MAY 1993

LEVEL PLAYING FIELD?

DESPITE a virtual press black-out, local actions are continuing against the pit closure programme. Dozens of towns have seen marches or rallies, and many of the 1984-5 Miners' Support Groups have been reactivated.

Some of the most dynamic actions have come from Women Against Pit Closures. In December they occupied the offices of Armthorpe colliery for a whole weekend, emerging to be cheered by a 500-strong crowd. In mid-January they set up non-stop 24-hour camps outside the ten pits threatened with immediate closure, promising to keep them going until the future of all pits is secured. On 6 February they organised a demo in London which won considerable support.

Both actions have breathed new life into a grassroots campaign, showing that we don't have to rely on scum like politicians or High Court judges. With redundancies piling up every day, the women who occupied Armthorpe know the score: "it's not just about the miners, it's everybody—health workers, British Rail, all of us."

Contact: National Miners' Support Network, 219 Mare Street, London E8 3QQ (tel. 081 985 1905); Women Against Pit Closures, tel. 0782 281246.

Class Warfare not Workfare

DEFY THE CHILD SUPPORT ACT

FROM April 1993 the new Child Support Act will be used to try to force single parents (usually women) on grants and benefits to name the absent parent of their children.

The government is setting up the "Child Support Agency" to track down these absent fathers and force them to pay "maintenance". The Treasury will pocket ALL the "maintenance" - the children will get NOTHING.

The Campaign against the Child Support Act is calling for a national campaign of non-cooperation with the Act to make it unworkable. Millions of people defied and defeated the Poll Tax. We could do this again against the Child Support Act. We have to work together locally and nationally to destroy this Act and similar attacks.

Pickets and protests have been held at official Child Support Agency presentations in Aberdeen, Bristol, Edinburgh, Glasgow, Heathrow, London and Manchester. The Campaign Against the Child Support Act has forced the DSS to back down in over 30 cases where they were illegally harassing single mothers. Now CACSA are holding a national conference in London on 20 February to co-ordinate grass-roots opposition.

CACSA, PO Box 287, London NW6 5QU. Tel. 071 837 7509.

RESIST ALL BENEFIT CUTS

BEATING drums, blowing whistles and ringing a cow bell, 25 protesting claimants invaded an Edinburgh Benefit Office on 26 January.

Part of the National Claimants Federation Week of Action, the demo was called by **Edinburgh Unemployed Workers Centre** to oppose the government's latest benefit cuts.

New regulations, introduced in December, remove benefits entirely from those judged not to be "actively seeking work". Previously these claimants could still receive 60% of income support. What's more, under the new rules claimants can have their benefit cut **without warning**.

"Any victimisation of claimants by the benefit authorities should be met by demonstrations and direct action at the benefit office responsible," urged the Edinburgh protesters - as for half an hour they drummed, blew whistles, paraded with placards and banners, made speeches and distributed leaflets to staff and claimants **inside** the High Riggs Unemployment Benefit Office.

Other Claimants Federation activity included an Action for Benefit Rights picket of the Central London Employment Services office on 28 January and mass Benefit Office leafleting by Swindon Unemployed Movement and Brighton Unemployed Workers Centre.

With John Major's February speech advocating "workfare" the need is clear for direct action by claimants and workers to **stop any such moves towards compulsory work for dole**.

EDINBURGH UNEMPLOYED WORKERS CENTRE, 103 Broughton St., Tel. 031 557 0718. Open 12-4pm weekdays. Postal address: EUWC, c/o 1st Floor, 20 Melville Terrace, Edinburgh EH9 1LY. ACTION FOR BENEFIT

RIGHTS c/o 11 Barnsbury Rd., London N1 0HG

Water belongs to everyone



WATER theft threatens Scotland. But local community groups are forming to sink government plans to introduce a water privatisation bill this autumn.

Broughton Hands Off Water in Edinburgh declare: "We promise the pirate privatisers that * We won't be paying the private water bills * There will be massive action and resistance against any disconnections or installation of water meters * water privatisation will be stopped."

3,000 marched in the Hands Off Our Water demo in Glasgow on 21 November, with speakers advocating non-payment. In January HOW activists cut off the water supply to the house of Scottish Secretary of State Ian Lang! Local groups already exist in Strathclyde and Lothian.

"We won't pay for privatised water" say 3,000 in Glasgow on 21 Nov...

8,000 took to the streets of Glasgow on 30 January to oppose water privatisation. But the strictly legal protest strategy advocated by the Labour Party and the STUC (the demo organisers) will never stop the Tory water thieves.

As with the poll tax, mass non-payment can win. And grass-roots activists must be ready to totally oppose the government's likely choice of the franchising option for Scottish water - a choice aimed at introducing the massively unpopular privatisation option gradually, through the back door.

In England and Wales water is already privatised. Bills and disconnections are soaring. But resistance has started. In October residents in 5 estates in Carshalton,

Surrey blocked roads to stop Thames Water contractors installing water meters. Some water stopcocks have been completely sealed with cement!

RESISTANCE IN EDINBURGH: Broughton 031 558 3153. Stockbridge New Town 667 4299. Haymarket Tollcross 229 7487.

ITALY

20,000 marched in Milan on 20 November as various grass-roots workers' organisations called a national strike against the government's austerity programme. While the level of struggle has fallen since autumn, and the self-organised workers' movement is experiencing some divisions, workers' direct actions - occupations, blockades of roads, railways etc. - continue round Italy.

✪ AGAINST RACISM, AGAINST FASCISM, AGAINST THE STATE ✪

HOW best to resist racism and fascism?

Anti racist activity must be based in everyday life in the community, in workplaces, in schools and colleges. Two good examples - Newham Monitoring Project in east London have organised anti racist street patrols in areas like Canning Town. When Kuldip Sekhon was murdered by a racist in January 1990, the Southall community organised a march and 1 day strike which effectively shut down the west London borough.

Fascists must be physically stopped from organising marches, meetings, paper sales or any public activity. This is vital to stop the racist harassment and attacks which the fascists incite and organise.

Simultaneously anti racists must resist the most powerful racists - the governments. EC governments, backed by their parliamentary 'oppositions' such as Britain's Labour Party, are combining to turn back refugees fleeing wars, imprisonment, torture and death - devastation itself a product of exploitation by multinationals, the International Monetary Fund, and western arms sales.

Racist state immigration controls are always linked to the profit needs of capitalism. In the booming 50's and 60's Western Europe welcomed immigrants as intended cheap labour. Now, with the recession, the EC are building Fortress Europe. **Anti racists must organise material support for, and solidarity with, refugees and all threatened with deportation.**

Anti racism should not be seen as a "single issue". For example Southall Black Sisters and the Southall Monitoring Group combine resistance to racism with opposition to male domestic violence and support for workers' struggles and community campaigns against injustice.

Britain's "national" anti fascist groups have significant weaknesses. The Anti Nazi League (SWP dominated) and the Anti Racist Alliance (Labour orientated) are not usually prepared to initiate mass direct action to stop the fascists. They do not seriously oppose state racism, and do nothing to promote anti capitalist struggle. Anti Fascist Action do have a positive policy of stopping the fascists..But everyday resistance to immigration controls, deportations, police oppression, and other institutionalised racism is equally vital.

And, crucially, fighting racism involves helping build widespread resistance to all capitalist attacks; in the course of such struggles black/white divisions can be overcome.

As the Southall Review say : **"The fight against racism in the final analysis is the fight against exploitation. It's a fight for class.... It is also a fight against imperialism. All the fights, for the sisters, the gays, they are all symbiotic, they cannot be divided."**

Thanks to Southall Monitoring Group/CAFE bulletin.

A GULF IN STANDARDS

The latest air-raids in southern Iraq have rebounded on the West. Not only did allied planes miss targets, kill 20 including civilians, and reinforce Saddam's power within Iraq. With Kurdish areas facing attack and marsh arabs still being persecuted, it also undermined the position of Arab states who supported the Gulf War. Reports reveal medical deformities among the Iraqi population arising from Allied bombing 2 years ago.

With Bush's departure from the White House, even UN 'glove puppet' Secretary-General Boutros Boutros-Ghali has come out against the "double standards" of selective implementation of UN resolutions. The episode of expelled palestinian Hamas sympathisers on a south Lebanon hillside, with the US in particular protecting Israel, is the clearest example of the double-standards built into the "new world order".

A Clean Up Act

The environmental crisis in Shetland surrounding the oil tanker, Braer, has illustrated the worldwide risk that capitalism poses to the survival of species. The overriding concern of Government and oil companies alike has been to clean up their image, tattered by this latest massive oil spillage.

As with the Exxon Valdez, off Alaska, the spectacle of threats to wilderness and wildlife (even more than their culpability over the Piper Alpha oil rig explosion, Herald of Free Enterprise ferry disaster etc) has exposed how vulnerable we are to the ravages of a system which places profit and exploitation before life. The course of the ship, it's lack of maintenance and 'Flags of Convenience' are all symptoms arising from an economy based on production for profit.

2 weeks later and a massive slick resulted from another ruptured tanker in the Malacca strait near northern Sumatra. Clearly such threats are global and we must destroy capitalism to survive.



WE'RE OUT HERE FOR THEM

There was an inspiring response to the support-appeals for jailed anarchists Kenny Tollia and Andre Villaverde.

Kenny was jailed after a police riot in New York. Support petitions were sent from Scotland, England, Sweden, Poland and the ex-USSR. Free Kenny demos rallied at US embassies in Warsaw, Minsk, and Moscow.

The International Day of Action for Peruvian anarchist Andre Villaverde (see C135) saw demos at Peruvian embassies and consulates in Budapest, Mexico City, Bonn, Hamburg, Ottawa, San Francisco, Los Angeles and New York

THEY'RE IN THERE FOR US African comrades are requesting urgent assistance. 4 members of the Nigerian (libertarian socialist) Awareness League were arrested during worker/student demos against increased repression as Nigeria squirms under the iron heel of a World Bank/IMF austerity programme. Despite an ostensible 'return to democracy', union-busting, press censorship, university closure and arbitrary arrest are commonplace.

The 4 - Udemba Chuks, Garba Adu, Kingsley Etioni and James Ndubuisi - are being held in inhuman conditions along with human rights activists, civil rights lawyers and student and trade union organisers. The Awareness League is calling for demos outside Nigerian embassies and consulates between 22 and 26 February. Donations are also much needed. For info contact : Awareness League, c/o Samuel Mbah, PO Box 28, Agbani, Enugu State, Nigeria. And Workers Solidarity Alliance, 339 Lafayette St. Rm. 202, NY, NY 10012, USA. Tel. 212 979 8353.

Fighting Burnsall Tyranny

Workers at Burnsall metal Finishing plant in Smithwick, West Midlands have been on strike since 15th June 1992!. The workers, mainly Asian women are fighting for a safe workplace, union recognition, equal pay and an end to excessive overtime.

Since the strike began, the police have constantly tried to intimidate the strikers and have, as usual, shown their outright support for the employers. Despite the managements attempts to mobilise scabs the strike has continued. On Saturdays the picket line frequently numbers 300.

A victory has already been won in that the DSS has agreed to backdate unemployment benefit on grounds of 'unfair dismissal' Solidarity action and a boycott of Burnsalls products is being sought. In the 90's with the ban on secondary picketing and other anti-

TEAR DOWN THE WALLS

Prisoners continue to fight back.

August '92: active resistance by women in Lexington (Kentucky) Federal Prison. About 100 women, including Jamaican, Haitian, Afro-American, Latina and white, refused to return to their cells, to protest racist staff brutality. 12 were immediately transferred; next day the protest continued and cells were set alight. One woman prisoner said "For a few moments we felt free."

12 December : Prisoners in Perth Prison, Scotland rioted and took a screw hostage to protest the soul-destroying practice of video-recording all visits from loved ones. 3 prisoners have been charged.

Christmas Day : 25 cons in top-security Long Lartin went on hunger-strike to highlight wrongful convictions and brutality. They were joined by prisoners in other jails.

Boxing Day : 50 untried prisoners in Reading Remand liberated and rearranged a wing in frustration at the too-long incarceration before trial. (Commonly more than a year. Over half of those remanded are eventually acquitted without recompense.) 8 screws were hospitalised. The insurgents then tried to smash through the main-gate in a prison van. 150 drafted-in screws crushed the revolt. **But they can't crush the spirit of revolt.**

28 December : Some Long Lartin prisoners still on hunger strike.

JOHN PEROTTI

Framed prison activist John Perotti is being subjected to increased harassment by the authorities. Send him a card, he needs your solidarity.

Cards and leaflets from JP Defence Fund, c/o 45a Bedford Ave., Aberdeen AB2 3YL
John Perotti, POB 1368, no.167712, Mansfield, Ohio 44901, USA.

Sources: Love and Rage, On Gogol Boulevard, Bad Attitude, Shotts prisoners. Compiled by Edinburgh ABC.

union legislation making it harder than ever to mobilise through traditional trade union structures, community action is vital
Info. : Burnsall Strikers' Support Committee, c/o Londec, Instrument House, 205/217 Kings Cross Rd, London WC1X 9DB Tel: 071 713 7907.



The boot is on the other foot

Up to 4 million people took to the streets of Germany towards the end of '92 - to protest against State racism and fascist violence. This included a rise in counter offensive attacks on neo-nazis.

On 8th November, 350,000 marched in **Berlin** at a Government sponsored rally. Faced with such hypocrisy, autonomists splattered politicians with paint & eggs. On 9th Nov 100,000 commemorated Kristallnacht, during which 40 Turks occupied the Christian Democrat regional office accusing them of complicity in racist murders. On 21st Nov., masked anti-fascists attacked a restaurant in **Erfurt** and smashed up the place & fascist diners. On 6th December in **Munich** and **Augsberg**, and 13th December in **Frankfurt** and **Hamburg** huge demonstrations occurred. On 12th December, Croat, Serb, Turkish and German workers from a local engineering firm held a silent march through **Dusseldorf**. With polls showing a huge drop in Nazi support on the refugee issue Nazi meetings were broken up in **Weisbaden** on 23rd Jan. as they complained of being "the victims of a pogrom".

250,000 demonstrated in **Vienna, Austria** on 23rd January against the anti-immigration policies of Jorg Haider & the so-called Freedom Party. Although their nationwide petition reached the 400,000 (7%) threshold to

Naked Aggression

In the north of the Philippines, villages such as Aguid have successfully resisted so-called "development" schemes which would destroy their communities & culture. Central Government plans to 'drown' villages, burial sites and fields to interfere with the Chico River and start large-scale mining were resisted on the initiative of women.

Faced with bulldozers, the women used a taboo against men viewing naked women to advance unclothed and the operators fled in panic. Elsewhere, in central Mindanao, the southern most island where a civil

force a parliamentary debate, this was less than half what the neo-fascists had predicted. In **Belgium** on 24th October, 50,000 demonstrated in **Brussels**.

In **Rome** on 9th November for Kristallnacht and 28th January throughout **Italy** huge protests took place. On 12th December, similar widespread protests commemorated the 23rd anniversary of the Piazza Fontana bombings by fascists and the state secret services. A neo-Nazi building was stormed by Italian Jewish youth objecting to anti-semitic stickers in Rome. Throughout Italy footballers protested against racist abuse from some fans.

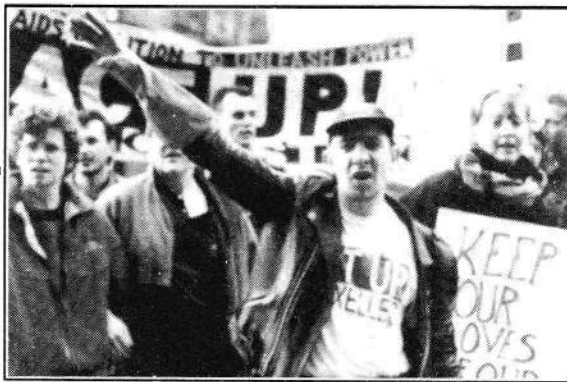
FIGHTING THE FORTRESS

In **Spain** 200 were mobilised in **Zaragossa** to defend a house squatted by a libertarian collective from attack by 200 fascists on 20th November. Next day, central **Madrid** was blocked off by a protest against the killing of a woman from the Dominican Republic. On the 22nd, in **Vitoria** and **Barcelona**, thousands marched against a deportation of 30 Algerians by the Civil Governor.

In **Britain**, community based campaigns against the planned deportation of William Weekes and Tony Deane are victorious. A campaign has been trying to prevent the Tory council in Ealing from chang-

war has been raging for decades, over 2,500 troops have been deployed to implement a Geo-thermal project on the slopes of Mt. Apo. Villagers are resisting the clearing of their forests and way of life.

In **India**, opposition to the massive Narmada Valley Development Project involving the "relocation" of a million people has forced a World Bank rethink of funding Dam building but this is only a stay in its execution and brutal repression against villagers continues.



Over 150 people joined an angry demonstration outside Leeds central police station to protest at police action at an earlier ACT-UP mobilisation, where three demonstrators had been arrested, held in isolation and questioned about their HIV status. Within half an hour of the picket, police chiefs conceded two of ACT-UP's three demands. Direct action gets the goods!

ing the name of Blair Peach schools in **Southall** (in memory of the murdered anti-Nazi activist). On 7th November, 1,000 people participated in a march to commemorate racist murders such as Prohit Duggal. The next day, in York and London anti-fascists were active against Nazis during 'Remembrance Sunday'.

On 28th November, 1,500 attended the annual march in **Glasgow** against racism & fascism, during which a small BNP counter demo was chased away by angry demonstrators & only saved from a beating by the police. On 17th December the Drummond Street Defence Campaign picketed **Acton** Magistrates Court in support of Muzibur Rahman and Sahab Uddin, 2 Bengalis framed by police. On 12th January in Stoke Newington 400 marched on the police station on the 10th anniversary of Colin Roach's death in police custody. On 23 January in **Edinburgh**, hundreds marched against the Asylum Bill which threatens to send refugees back to torture or death. The speeches were by activists rather than politicians. On 29th Jan. 3 **Newham** Monitoring staff were ambushed by a group of white racists using weapons, Hossein Zahir received severe head injuries but is recovering. On 2 Feb. charges of threatening behaviour were dropped against a victim of police assault, Gill Smith in **Newham** East Info: PO Box 273, Forest Gate, London E7. Tel. 081-555-8151.

More ANTI RACIST CONTACTS

Southall Monitoring Group, 6a South Rd., Southall, Middlesex UB1 1RT. Tel. 081 843 2333.

Refugees Ad Hoc Committee for Asylum Rights Tel. 071 738 6408.

Anti Fascist Action Northern Network, Box 151, 52 Call Lane, Leeds LS1 6DT. Lothian Campaign Against Racism and Fascism, PO Box 474, Edinburgh EH11 2QT.

Info on Germany from Anti-Racism office, Sietwall 38, 2800 Bremen.

A WORLD TO WIN

Building Resistance:

On the average 3 building workers are killed every week. In light of this the Construction Safety Campaign (CSC) organised a march in London on 25th November '92 which was attended by 1,000 building workers, supporters, and relatives of those who had been killed or maimed in the construction industry.

Counter Information is doing a fuller article in the near future, from asbestos poisoning to negligence. Any info on the subject of resistance to this would be much appreciated.

United - We Win!

The decision of Hoover workers in Cambuslang, Glasgow to accept lower wages in order to attract more jobs is a mistake. Outraged by Hoover's plans to close their factory as a result workers in Dijon, France are campaigning against present-day policies of playing one group of workers off against another. Remember, capitalism has no national allegiance!

Contesting Conquest

A threat to disrupt a Columbus Day parade by 500 supporters of the American Indian Movement was successful on Oct. 11th '92 in Denver, Colorado. Elsewhere in Mexico and Bolivia tens of thousands of peasants protested and in Ecuador, Indians blocked the Pan-American highway. In San Francisco, a staged "re-enactment" of the landing was disrupted by a breakaway group of 200 from a tame leftist march.

(info Profane Existence).

Revolting Pupils

Agitation in Athens and other Greek towns includes occupations of 140 schools by school students revolting against imposed exams.

Sanity Claus!

Late December, Paris, France; Around 100 homeless people took over the lobby of the luxury George V hotel to hold a Christmas party. During the party homeless children were given presents. The party was arranged to highlight the lack of housing available to the poor.

Riots & Molotovs

9-11 Oct; At Vaulx en Velin (in Lyon) an eighteen year old youth who had to pass a police blockade was beaten by a cop. In reaction to this, during 3 days, 150 to 400 set fire to cars and attacked the police station with molotovs, stones, fire etc. 8 youths were arrested by the 300 police brought from Lyon to "restore order". The police chief, who had to justify the violence and repression, declared "This was nothing like a social revolt. These acts were committed by delinquents".

16 Oct; About 30 youths attacked a police station in Asnieres (Paris suburb) with incendiary bombs and molotovs. Four cops were injured. This followed the death of a 24 year old man who committed suicide after his arrest. (A.Infos, France)



Women march in Leeds (photo Paula Solloway)

WOMEN took to the streets of Leeds in January in a show of strength and solidarity. After a series of rapes and assaults women have received scaremongering 'advice' from media and police to stay at home and never travel alone. A busy junction was blocked for half an hour by demonstrators asserting their freedom to travel wherever, whenever and however, in safety.

A similar demo took place in Edinburgh on 29 January when women marched to "Reclaim the Night," while in December marchers in Cardiff demanded better street lighting and evening transport. On 28 November 4,000 women demonstrated in London to mark the International Day to End Violence against Women and protest against world-wide attacks on women's rights and bodies.

CONTRA-FLOW

AN important struggle against ruling class transport needs is going on near Winchester. Faced with the Dept of Transport decision to cut through Twyford Down to plug a gap in the M3, 40 or so people camped out on the site, including around 10 who call themselves the 'Donga tribe.'

'Donga' refers to the Down's many Iron Age (Celtic) trackways, some of which are up to 20 feet deep. The land also contains a prehistoric village. Active resistance has continued for over a year.

In December, after Winchester College took the squatters to court to evict them, 80 security men with bulldozers steamed into the pathways. People resisted, throwing themselves in front of bulldozers and climbing trees, but were finally beaten with considerable violence. Some women protesters were sexually assaulted.

Twyford Down is a funny struggle. First, the local Great and Good, mainly Tory, clearly object to Whitehall johnnies interfering on their patch, and some even seem to back the squatters. This can only obscure the relatively recent appearance in one of England's snottiest-nosed cities of a stratum of caravan-dwelling long-term unemployed people, whose tendency to stand together on the Down 'issue' must be causing serious shivers among College masters, local judiciary, clergy and the rich.

Second, there are the 'Donga' minority: while they

RECLAIM THE STREETS!

IN BRITAIN cars and lorries kill 5000 and injure 200,000 each year. In what used to be safe play areas and vibrant meeting places they also cause untold levels of ill health, lead-poisoning, noise-related stress, aggravated asthma, etc.

Residents of Tottenham, London, sick of child-deaths, pollution, rat-runs, danger-spots and lorries on the streets, have started to fight back. Already residents of Dorset Road have blocked roads to stop commercial lorries putting children in danger; people in Mount Pleasant Road won speed restrictions after putting up homemade signs saying '20 MPH ZONE'; and 100 adults and children set up a road block in Green Lanes. Info: Tottenham Community Action, T'ham Solidarity Group meets every other Tuesday at 72 Wood Green Road at 7.30. Tel 081 802 9804.

are against the government and are taking direct action, they also make an absurd appeal to the Royal family to save the Down!

More positively, though, also in December, Winchester Class War organised the city's first ever 'March Against the Rich.' Excellent! Road-blocking and direct resistance to Tarmac is good, but we hope that in '93 the trouble on the Down will spread into the town itself. Bollocks to the Queen! As the American anarchist Lucy Parsons put it: "Devastate the avenues where the wealthy live!"

South Downs Earth First!, c/o Prior House, Tilbury Place, Brighton BN2. Earth Info Line 0225 44133.

NURSES' ACTION

LONDON HOSPITALS were put on official alert in early January because of a beds/cash shortage. Patients were thrown out and only emergencies admitted. The government want to shut 1 in 4 London hospitals, with similar closures elsewhere.

In late November a nurses' strike and occupation at

University College Hospital forced the reopening of a 22 bed ward, the promise of consultation in future, the return of student nurses to the ward and no victimisation for those taking part. Patients, porters and the local community all gave support.

Now the authorities want to shut UCH completely in July. Determined to fight, workers have already voted to ballot for an occupation.

Class War: PO Box 1021, Edinburgh EH8 9PW; PO Box 496, Glasgow G14 0PG (Britain-wide & international)
London Greenpeace, 5 Caledonian Rd., London N1
Norwich Solidarity Centre and Norwich Direct Action Movement - both at: PO Box 73, Norwich NR1 2EB
Stockbridge New Town Solidarity Network, c/o J.Ball, 24 Dean Pk. St., Edinburgh EH4 1JT
Tottenham Solidarity Network, c/o 72 West Green Rd., London N15

(If your group would like to be considered for listing, please write to CI in Edinburgh.)

GET INVOLVED !

If you like Counter Info, we invite you to write to us, and also to the other groups listed below:

AK Distribution, 22 Lutton Place, Edinburgh (mags, pamphlets, books - write for new catalogue)

Anarchist Communist Federation, c/o 84b Whitechapel High St., London E1 7QX (contacts Britain-wide)

Attack International BM6577 London WCIN 3XX

Autonomous Assembly, c/o FUN, 28 King St., Glasgow G1 5QP (network to link struggles in Scotland)

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For all other matters please write COUNTER INFO, PIGEONHOLE CI, C/O 11 FORTH ST., EDINBURGH EH1, SCOTLAND.

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WORLD TO WIN

DAN DARE

A DISABLED anti "Children in Need" demo on 20 November saw over 70 people blocking entrances to the BBC TV studios in London.

"Disabled children are in need because television portrays them as either pathetic, sad victims or courageous brave heroes. The BBC must put a stop to abuses of this nature. They have not got our permission," stated the Direct Action Network.

DAN, 68 Alexandra Court, Empire Way, London HA9 0QP.

IN THE ANTI TELETHON action in July '92 a 1,000 strong crowd burst from the confines of its barricades and blocked the entrances to the London Weekend TV studios.

These protests highlight the fact that disabled people should have their needs met as of right rather than being forced to rely on charity.

GOING, GOING....

THE HATED poll tax will be abolished in April. Resistance continues to collection efforts. November saw crowds of locals successfully defending non-payers' homes in West Lothian from sheriff officers. In Lambeth 41% have yet to pay a penny!

The introduction of the replacement Council Tax is being accompanied by massive cuts in Council jobs and services. Scattered anti cuts strikes are breaking out in Councils country-wide.

Lothian APT Hotline 031 557 0718. London Fight the Poll Tax 081 692 9181 (John). NW APT Forum 061 707 1584 (info on public services/ communities unity conferences)

THE McLIBEL TWO

THE McLIBEL Support Campaign are calling for a week of protests before the libel trial of the 2 London Greenpeace supporters being sued by McDonalds Hamburger Corp.. A demo will besiege the High Court on the first day of the trial, expected this summer. **McLibel SC, London Greenpeace, 5 Caledonian Rd, London N1. 081 837 7557.**

Liquidating the Stock

Workers occupying a Forges de Clabecq steelworks in Belgium protesting about a threatened 10% payout in December seized 7,000 bottles of wine from the Company cellars and threatened to sell them at 200 francs each.

EMERGENCY APPEAL

AS we go to the printers we are well short of the cash needed to meet our postage and print costs. Please send donations as soon as possible, to enable us to continue publishing Counter Info.